

Arthur Bragança

(Last Update: May 2026)

I: World Bank

L: Brasília, Brazil

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PERSONAL INFORMATION

Full Name: Arthur Amorim Bragança

Date of Birth: December 7, 1985

Nationality: Brazilian

CURRENT EMPLOYMENT

The World Bank

Senior Economist: 2022–

Works at the intersection of research and policy on land use change, deforestation, sustainable agriculture, and climate and nature finance. Manages a diverse portfolio of investment projects and technical cooperation programs, coordinating multidisciplinary teams, supervising budgets, and engaging a diverse group of stakeholders.

Technical cooperation programs: Leads large technical cooperation programs focused on designing and implementing better public policies across Latin America. Currently manages two programs (USD 5 million each) with the Government of Brazil, covering: (i) the implementation of the Forest Code and related financial instruments; (ii) reforms and scale-up of payment for ecosystem services programs; (iii) the design of policies to support bio-economy and forest restoration value chains; (iv) the design and implementation of Brazil's Emissions Trading System;

Investment project management: Leads the design, preparation, and supervision of investment projects in the environment and agriculture sectors (portfolio exceeding USD 1 billion since joining the World Bank). Manages project cycles end-to-end. Currently leads a USD 147 million investment project on forest restoration with a local development bank and a USD 200 million sustainable agriculture project with a state government.

Strategic contributions: Contributes to the design of additional investment projects, the development of innovative financial solutions in the climate and nature finance space, and the preparation of technical inputs, strategies, and analytical reports for World Bank management and public audiences.

External engagement: Represents the World Bank in high-level conferences and technical meetings, engages with bilateral and multilateral donors, and leads dissemination of results.

PREVIOUS EMPLOYMENT

Climate Policy Initiative, PUC-Rio

Head of Policy Evaluation: 2019–2022

Senior Analyst: 2018–2019

Led the team working on sustainable agriculture and infrastructure. Prepared grant proposals, supervised technical research teams, and engaged with government counterparts, funders (including the NICFI, Gordon & Betty Moore Foundation, ClimateWorks, WWF, and others), and NGOs.

TRACES

Economist: 2015–2018

Led the economics team, with a focus on economic modeling.

TEACHING

ENAp (Brazilian National School of Public Administration)

Invited Professor (part time): 2022–

- Teaches Econometrics and Quantitative Methods at the Masters in Monitoring and Evaluation of Public Policies. Advises students on their masters theses.

Department of Economics, PUC-Rio

Lecturer: 2016–2022

- Taught Econometrics, Introduction to Statistics, and Introduction to Economics at the undergraduate level. Advised students on their final essays (monographs) for the Bachelor's degree in Economics.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, PUC-Rio, 2009–2014

Supervisors: [Juliano Assunção](#) and [Claudio Ferraz](#)

Visiting Ph.D. Student, Harvard University (2013)

B.A. in Economics, Federal University of Minas Gerais (UFMG), 2004–2008

Visiting Student, Queen Mary University of London (2007)

PROFESSIONAL INTERESTS

Land Use, Deforestation, Sustainable Agriculture, Climate and Nature Finance

LANGUAGES

Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (fluent)

PUBLICATIONS

1. "Transportation Infrastructure and Deforestation in the Amazon" (with [Juliano Assunção](#) and [Rafael Araújo](#)), *Journal of Development Economics*, vol. 177, 2025. DOI
2. "Cutting Special Interests by the Root: Evidence from the Brazilian Amazon" (with [Ricardo Dahis](#)). *Journal of Public Economics*, vol. 215, 2022. DOI
3. "Extension Services Can Promote Pasture Restoration: Evidence from Brazil's Low Carbon Agriculture Plan" (with [Peter Newton](#), [Avery Cohn](#), [Juliano Assunção](#), [Cristiane Camboim](#), [Diego de Faveri](#), [Barbara Farinelli](#), [Viviana Perego](#), [Mateus Tavares](#), [Janei Resende](#), [Sidney de Medeiros](#), and [Timothy Searchinger](#)), *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, vol. 119(12), 2022. DOI
4. "Geographic Heterogeneity and Technology Adoption: Evidence from Brazil" (with [Juliano Assunção](#) and [Pedro Hemsley](#)), *Land Economics*, vol. 95(4), pp. 599–616, 2019. DOI
5. "Predicting Intensification on the Brazilian Agricultural Frontier: Combining Evidence from Lab-In-The-Field Experiments and Household Surveys" (with [Avery Cohn](#)), *Land*, vol. 8(1), 21, 2019. DOI
6. "The Effects of Crop-to-Beef Prices on Deforestation: Evidence from the Tapajós Basin," *Environment and Development Economics*, vol. 23(4), pp. 391–412, 2018. DOI.
7. "The Economic Consequences of the Agricultural Expansion in Matopiba," *Revista Brasileira de Economia*, vol. 72, p. 161–185, 2018. DOI

WORKING PAPERS

8. "The Long Run Effects of Forest Incentives in Guatemala" (with [Romero Rocha](#)), January 2026. Revise & Resubmit, *Environment and Development Economics*
9. "Decentralization, Tax Administration, and Taxation: Evidence from Brazil's Rural Land Tax" (with [Diogo Britto](#), [Alexandre Fonseca](#), [Davi Moura](#), [Breno Sampaio](#), [André Sant'anna](#), and [Dimitri Szerman](#)), February 2026. *Submitted*.
10. "Quantifying the Carbon Preserved by Protected Areas in the Amazon" (with [Eduardo Adames](#), [Rafael Araújo](#), [Francisco Costa](#), [Frank Gentile](#), [Marcelo Sant'anna](#)), February 2026. *Submitted*.
11. "The Long Run Effects of Forest Incentives in Guatemala" (with [Mariana Conte Grand](#) and [Nicolas Borchers](#)), *In preparation*.

12. "The Short and Long Run Effects of Technological Change on Deforestation" (with Juliano Assunção), *In preparation*.
13. "Whose Tree Is It Anyway? Property Rights and Deforestation in the Brazilian Amazon" (with Rodrigo Adão, Jonathan Dingel, and Esteban Rossi-Hansberg), *In preparation*.

POLICY PAPERS

14. "Forest Restoration in Brazil: An Overview Report" (multiple authors), *In preparation*.
15. "Impacts of deforestation free regulations on smallholders in LAC" (with Lucas Zavala and Eduardo Fraga), *In preparation*.
16. "Improving Integrated Fire Management in Brazil: Impacts, Lessons, and Opportunities" (with Mariana Conte Grand and Julio Meir Barros), *In preparation*.
17. "Paraguay Country Climate and Development Report," (with Julie Rozenberg, Pui Shen Yoong, Javier Morales Sarriera, Paulina Estela Schulz Antipa, Mariana Conte Grand), *World Bank*, August 2025.
18. "Guatemala's Forest Incentive Programs: Impacts, Lessons, and Possibilities for Reform," (with Mariana Conte Grand and Nicolas Borchers), *World Bank*, July 2024.
19. "Mining Royalties and Socioeconomic Development in the State of Pará," (with Rafael Araújo), *Climate Policy Initiative*, July 2022.
20. "Roadmap for Sustainable Infrastructure in the Amazon," (with Joana Chiavari, Luiza Antonaccio, Brenda Prallon, Rafael Araújo, Gabriel Cozendey, and Ana Cristina Barros), *Climate Policy Initiative*, July 2022.
21. "Redefining Priorities in Infrastructure Development in the Amazon: Evidence from the State of Pará," (with Mateus Moraes), *Climate Policy Initiative*, May 2022.
22. "Accessibility in the Legal Amazon: Digital Solutions," (with Rafael Araújo and Juliano Assunção), *Amazônia 2030*, May 2022.
23. "Accessibility in the Legal Amazon: Delimiting the Area of Influence and Environmental Risks," (with Rafael Araújo and Juliano Assunção), *Amazônia 2030*, May 2022.
24. "Accessibility in the Legal Amazon: Measuring Market Access," (with Rafael Araújo and Juliano Assunção), *Amazônia 2030*, May 2022.

25. "The Economics of Cattle Ranching in the Amazon: Land Grabbing or Pushing the Agricultural Frontier?," (with Francisco Luis Lima Filho and Juliano Assunção), *Climate Policy Initiative*, October 2021.
26. "Governance, Area of Influence, and Environmental Risks of Transport Infrastructure Investments," (with Luiza Antonaccio, Brenda Prallon, Rafael Araújo, Ana Cristina Barros, and Joana Chiavari), *Climate Policy Initiative*, September 2021.
27. "Increasing Cattle Productivity in the Amazon Requires New Technologies," (with Francisco Luis Lima Filho and Juliano Assunção), *Climate Policy Initiative*, June 2021.
28. "Measuring the Indirect Effects of Transportation Infrastructure in the Amazon," (with Juliano Assunção and Rafael Araújo), *Climate Policy Initiative*, October 2020.
29. "The Need to Better Define and Delimit the Area of Influence for Infrastructure Projects," (with Luiza Antonaccio, Ana Cristina Barros, and Joana Chiavari), *Climate Policy Initiative*, August 2020.
30. "The Environmental Impacts of the Ferrogrão Railroad: an *Ex-ante* Evaluation of Deforestation Risks," (with Juliano Assunção and Rafael Araújo), *Climate Policy Initiative*, March 2020.
31. "Productivity for Cattle Ranching in Brazil: Pastureland Declines Might Show a New Pathway," (with Juliano Assunção), *Climate Policy Initiative*, November 2019.
32. "Pathways for Sustainable Agricultural Production in Brazil," (with Juliano Assunção), *Climate Policy Initiative*, June 2019.
33. "The Dynamics of Agricultural Technology Adoption in Brazil: Evidence Shows Three Distinct Patterns of Technology Uptake," (with Juliano Assunção), *Climate Policy Initiative*, October 2018.
34. "High Productivity Agricultural Techniques in Brazil: Adoption Barriers and Potential Solutions," (with Juliano Assunção and Pedro Hemsley), October 2013.

MEDIA

Nexo, Poder 360, Mongabay, Folha de São Paulo, Veja, Nexo Políticas Públicas (1), Nexo Políticas Públicas (2), Globo Rural, Valor Econômico (1), Valor Econômico (2), O Globo, A Granja

RESEARCH ASSISTANTS (W/ SUBSEQUENT PLACEMENT)

Wallace Innocencio (PhD in Economics, London School of Economics), Manuela Magalhães (PhD in Economics, Stanford University), Mateus Morais (PhD in Economics, London School of Economics), Brenda Prallon (PhD in Economics, Cornell University), Helena Arruda (Masters in Public Administration, FGV EAESP), Pedro Fernandes (Masters in Economics, Toulouse School of Economics), Julio Barros (Masters in Public Administration, Columbia University)

OTHER PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Consulting: The World Bank (pre 2022), The Global Commission on the Economy and Climate

Seminar and Conferences: World Bank Land Conference, FGV EBAPE, UFRJ, Princeton, UFV, Insper, RIDGE Forum on Political Economy, NEUDC, SBE Virtual Meeting, USP, The World Bank, AERE Summer Conference, Meeting of the Brazilian Econometric Society, LACEA/LAMES, CEDEPLAR/UFGM, PUC-Chile Economic History Lab, Fucape Business School, Italian Summer School in Development Economics, Harvard DRCLAS, Brown PTSC.

Referees: Nature Sustainability, Nature Food, Journal of Development Economics, Economic Journal, Journal of Environmental Economics and Management, Environment and Development Economics, Land Economics, Land Use Policy, Agricultural Economics, Economia, Revista Brasileira de Economia

Committees: Giovana Cavalca Meirelles Reis (MSc, FGV EESP, 2025), Patricia Amadi (PhD, FGV EESP, 2025), Julia Diniz Calatrone (MSc, ENAp, 2024), João Vitor Vial Marchi (MSc, FGV EESP, 2023), Thiago Pereira Lobo (PhD, FGV EESP, 2023), Isabella Meyer (MSc, UFRJ, 2023), Rodrigo Duarte Dourado (MSc, ENAp, 2022), Cicero Francisco de Lima (PhD, UFC, 2022), Lucas de Almeida Nogueira da Costa (MSc, UFRJ, 2022), Felipe Spiri (MSc, Insper, 2021), Pedro Levy Schott Pacheco (MSc, FGV EPGE, 2021), Katia Aiko Nishiyama Alves (PhD, FGV EPGE, 2020), Brenda Prallon (MSc, FGV-EMAP, 2020), Roberta Olivieri (MSc, PUC-Rio, 2020), Nathalia Sales (MSc, UFRJ, 2020), Livia Gouvêa Gomes (PhD, PUC-Rio, 2019), Roberta Beck Tabajara (MSc, PUC-Rio, 2019), Bruno Zanotto Vigna (PhD, UFRJ, 2019), Aparajita Das (PhD, PUC-Rio, 2018), Pedro Fernandes (MSc, UFRJ, 2018), Andre Albuquerque Sant'anna (PhD, UFRJ, 2018), Marcelo Dias Paes Ferreira (PhD, UFV, 2015), Vitória Rabello de Castro (MSc, PUC-Rio, 2015)